IELTS ADVANTAGE

Sentence Completion Questions Strategy Practice

The environmental impact of fashion

The fashion industry is one of the major polluting industries in the world. The production and distribution of the crops, fibers and garments used in fashion all contribute to differing forms of environmental pollution, including water, air, and soil pollution. The textile industry is the second greatest polluter of local freshwater in the world. Some of the main factors that contribute to this industrial pollution are the vast overproduction of fashion items, the use of synthetic fibers, and the agricultural pollution caused by the use of fashion crops.

The quantity of new garments bought by Americans has tripled since the 1960s. This exponential increase has caused the need for more resources, and the need for a speedier process in which clothes are produced. One of the main contributors to the rapid production of pollution is the rapid production of clothes due to increased consumption. Every year the world as a whole consumes more than 80 billion items of clothing. Those clothes contribute to resource pollution and waste pollution due to the fact that most of these items will one day be thrown out. People are consuming more and they want it for cheaper prices, and the companies producing these cheap items, which are making a profit, want the clothes as fast as possible. This creates a trend called fast fashion. Fast fashion is an approach to the design, creation, and marketing of clothing fashions that emphasizes making fashion trends quickly and cheaply available to consumers. The idea is that speedy mass production combined with cheap labor will make clothes cheaper for those buying them, thus leading to increased sales.

The main concern with fast fashion is the clothes waste it produces. According to the Environmental Protection Agency, 15.1 million tons of textile clothing waste was produced in 2013 alone. When textile clothing ends up in landfills, the chemicals in the clothes, such as the dye, can cause environmental problems because they gradually seep into the ground. On top of that, there is also the issue of so much used clothing waste needing to be disposed of in an ever increasing number of landfill sites. Moreover, when unsold clothes are burned, a copious amount of CO2 is released into the atmosphere. As per a World Resources Institute report, 1.2 billion tons of CO2 is released into the atmosphere per year by the fast fashion industry. In 2019, it was announced that France was making an effort to prevent companies from carrying out the practice of incinerating unsold fashion items.

Now that there is a continuous increase in the amount of clothing that is consumed, another issue that arises is that a lot of the clothing is no longer made from natural

Note: This is not a real IELTS test. This practice test is to give you an opportunity to practise implementing the strategies from the course. It does not reflect the scores, time needed or level of difficulty of a real IELTS test.

materials and crops. Clothing used to be produced from mainly "natural fibers" such as wool, cotton or silk, but nowadays inexpensive synthetic textile fibers such as polyester or nylon are becoming increasingly common. Polyester is one of the most popular fibers used in fashion today, and it is found in about 60% of garments in retail stores, which is about 21.3 million tons of polyester. The popularity of polyester keeps increasing as well, as can be seen from the fact that there was a 157 percent increase in polyester clothing consumption from 2000 to 2015.

Synthetic polyester is made from a chemical reaction involving coal, petroleum, air and water. When coal is burned, it emits a large amount of carbon dioxide into the atmosphere, and the use of petroleum in the process releases several air pollutants, such as particulate matter, nitrogen oxides, carbon monoxide, hydrogen sulphide and sulphur dioxide. Moreover, polyester is "non-biodegradable", meaning it can never be converted into a state that is naturally found in the natural world. Due to all of the time and resources it takes to make polyester and it never being able to revert to a state that can contribute to any natural nutrient cycles, polyester can be considered energy intensive with no net gain. When polyester clothing is washed, microplastics, which are extremely small pieces of plastic resulting from the breakdown of consumer products, are shed and enter the water system, which leads to micro pollution in waterways, including oceans. Due to the small size of the micro pollutants, it is easy for fish within waterways to absorb them in their body fat. The fish can then be consumed by humans, and these humans will also absorb the polyester micro pollutants in the fish in a process called biomagnification.

While synthetic fibers have a significant negative impact on the environment, natural fibers also contribute to pollution through agricultural pollution. Cotton production requires a large amount of pesticides and water usage. Cotton is considered the world's dirtiest crop because it uses 16% of the world's pesticides. Two of the main ingredients in pesticides are nitrates and phosphates. When the pesticides leak into stream systems surrounding the cropland, the nitrates and phosphates contribute to water eutrophication. Water eutrophication is an environmental phenomenon that causes a depletion of oxygen when the nutrient overload from pesticides causes a boom in plant growth and death. As regards wool, it is made from the fur of sheep, and sheep are ruminants and hence produce methane, which is a very potent greenhouse gas. The same problem exists for leather as cattle are ruminants too. For temperate zones, linen, which is made from flax, is considered a better alternative. Hemp, seaweed and biofabricated leather are other options that are becoming increasingly viable.

Note: This is not a real IELTS test. This practice test is to give you an opportunity to practise implementing the strategies from the course. It does not reflect the scores, time needed or level of difficulty of a real IELTS test.

Sentence Completion Questions Strategy Practice

Source: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Environmental_impact_of_fashion

Questions 1-10
Complete the sentences below.
Choose ***NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER*** *from the text for each answer.*

1. The second biggest contributor to the pollution of ……. is the textile industry.
2. There has been a threefold increase in the quantity of ……. which have been purchased in the United States since the 60s.
3. Over ……. garments are bought by consumers annually.
4. ……. is the term used to refer to the approach of making access to the latest fashions speedy and affordable.
5. The quantity of ……. is going up all the time as a result of the large number of used garments that are thrown away.
6. There has been an initiative in ……. to stop the fashion industry from burning clothing that has not been sold.
7. ……. is a synthetic fibre which is found in the majority of clothing items being sold today.
8. Sulphur dioxide is one byproduct that comes from using ……. to make polyester.
9. Tiny plastic particles eventually reach oceans and fish as a result of garments being ……. .
10. A reduction in the level of ……. is brought about by the rapid increase in the growth and death of plant material due to pesticides.

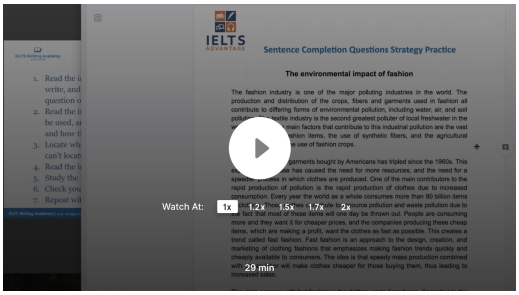
Note: This is not a real IELTS test. This practice test is to give you an opportunity to practise implementing the strategies from the course. It does not reflect the scores, time needed or level of difficulty of a real IELTS test.

Sentence Completion Questions Strategy Practice

Answer Key:

Answer guidance video:

https://www.loom.com/share/810305a3f28a465e922d3c50671132a2



1. local freshwater	Extra info- para 1
2. new garments	Extra info- para 2
3. 80/eighty billion	Extra info- para 2
4. Fast fashion	Extra info- para 2
5. landfill sites	Extra info- para 3
6. France	Extra info- para 3
7. Polyester	Extra info- para 4
8. petroleum	Extra info- para 5
9. washed	Extra info- para 5
10. oxygen	Extra info- para 6

Note: This is not a real IELTS test. This practice test is to give you an opportunity to practise implementing the strategies from the course. It does not reflect the scores, time needed or level of difficulty of a real IELTS test.